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July 24, 2023

The Foundation

NFL Strategic Business Outcomes

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NFL Tech Innovation Framework

NFL Technology Innovation Hub

Mission & Goals

	Strategic Alignment	Align the NFL's portfolio of innovation investments with its critical business outcomes
	Consistency	Provide a consistent, enterprise-wide approach to identify, prioritize, measure, and successfully deliver major innovation initiatives and projects
	Accountability	Utilize venture investment metrics to measure innovation project performance and delivery timetable
	Repeatability	Create a standardized and repeatable demand management, capacity planning and project prioritization management framework, vocabulary, and toolset
	Visibility	Empower stakeholders with a commitment to clarity, openness, and honesty, ensuring every aspect of our program is accessible, understandable, and accountable

Why an **Innovation** Framework?

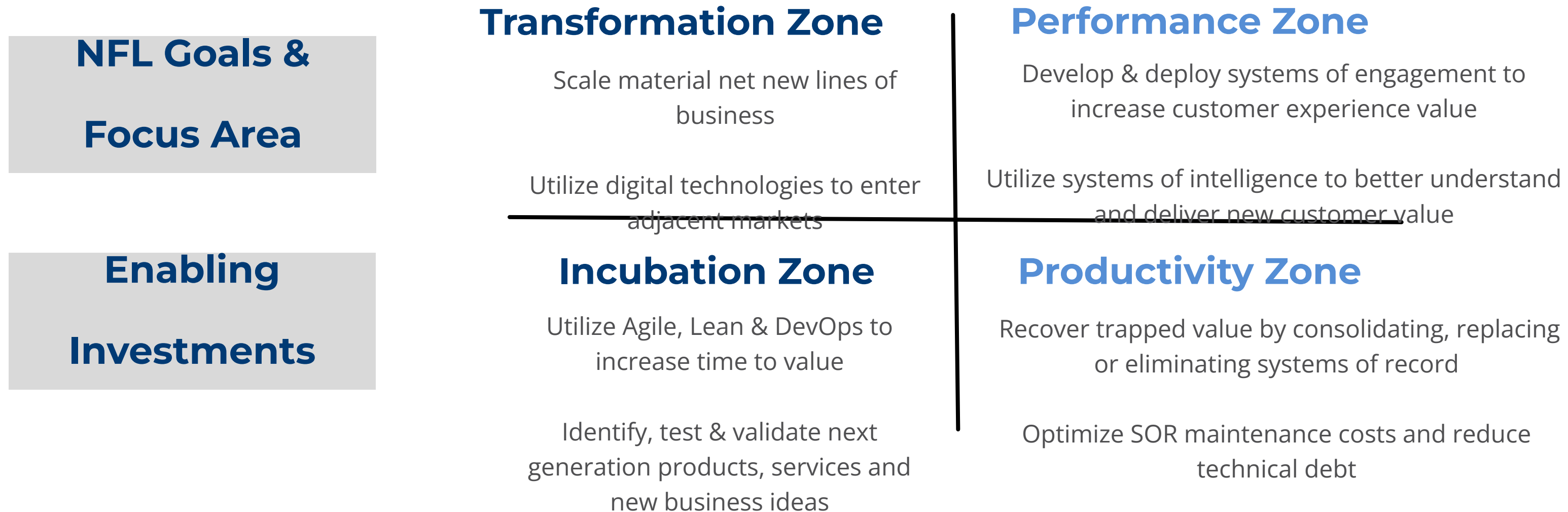
Having an innovation framework is crucial in the digital transformation process as it allows an organization to discover, cultivate, and execute innovative and inventive concepts to drive strategic success.

- Benefits the discovery of new and imaginative approaches
- Reviews the positive and negative aspects of each option
- Makes decisions based on accurate and reliable information
- Develops strategies to translate ideas into business opportunities

Why is a **framework** needed at the NFL?

- To address the lack of monitoring and measuring of technology innovation projects and ideas
- Eliminate siloed pockets of innovation and redundant projects
- Leverage ideas from all levels of the organization
- Strengthen brain power through increased collaboration
- Foster creativity by working as a connected NFL (networked, flexible, and learning) organization
- Solve complex business problems collectively to enhance the game.

4 Zones Model: Business Value Creation



Sustaining innovation: extension and improvements to already existing innovations inside the organizations

Disruptive innovation: new business models and operating models

Sustaining Innovation: Run the Business

Performance Zone

**Increase Consumption |
Fan Growth | Grow Key
Demographics**

Productivity Zone

- Technology that drives the execution of League Strategic Goals
- Charged with serving the organization's customers and creating near-term financial returns. It represents the revenue generation arm of your business today. It provides the operating income to fund both your current and future operations
- Shared service investments and programs that serve to optimize the core business.
- Maintains efficiency and compliance and delivers optimization
- Charged with making the performance zone more efficient and more effective as well as insuring it complies with all regulations. It consists of all the cost-center functions that provide these services, an expense that is subtracted from your performance zone revenue, along with the latter's cost of goods, to produce your operating income.

Disruptive Innovation: Grow the Business

Transformation Zone

**Increase Consumption |
Fan Growth | Grow Key
Demographics**

- The goal is to undertake a transformational initiative to put the NFL on a significantly different trajectory

Incubation Zone

- New offers and products in emerging and/or fast-growing markets that could someday be a game changer for the business.
- Charged with exploring new products, services and businesses that can leverage new digital technologies and potentially have a significant impact on future business growth opportunities. It also serves as the staging area for all innovation projects. Includes: project prioritization, demand management and governance processes.

NFL Tech Innovation Framework - Incubation Zone

- The **NFL Tech Innovation HUB** is charged with exploring new products, services and businesses that can leverage new digital technologies and potentially have a significant impact on future business growth opportunities. It also serves as the staging area for all major projects and includes project prioritization, demand management and resource allocation governance processes.
- Accelerate⁹ the organization's ability to identify, test and validate next generation product and service ideas and leverage digital technology enabled innovation to develop and deliver them
- Learning faster for sustainable competitive advantage

NFL Tech Innovation HUB - The Next Big Wave

In the rapidly evolving technological landscape, businesses need a nucleus of innovation to drive competitive advantage. The **NFL Tech Innovation HUB** is conceived as a cutting-edge initiative integrating disruptive technology with business strategy, offering an environment for incubating future business ideas while ensuring robust governance (**NFL Innovation Framework**) and a collaborative approach.

9



NFL Tech Innovation HUB - Strategic Outcomes

- 1. Alignment of Technology and Business Strategy:** The hub ensures that technological advancements are congruent with business goals, offering a seamless path for businesses to adopt, adapt, and scale new technologies effectively.
- 2. Incubation of Future Business Strategies:** By serving as a birthplace for innovative ideas, the hub fosters an environment where fledgling business strategies can be tested, refined, and matured, using technology as a driving force.
- 3. Collaborative Ecosystem for Innovation:** The introduction of an innovation steering committee guarantees that stakeholders, including tech innovation partners, are aligned, have a voice, and work collaboratively towards shared objectives.
- 4. Robust Governance Model:** The hub's customized framework ensures that the adoption and adaptation of disruptive technologies are executed within a structured, risk-mitigated environment, ensuring compliance, security, and optimal utilization.



NFL Tech Innovation HUB - The Next Big Wave

The NFL Tech Innovation HUB can be leveraged to develop new value propositions and take them from concept to thriving startup. The goal is for the framework/HUB is to act as a catalyst tool to stimulate innovation and create a pipeline of successful new ventures.

New ventures are developed strategically using existing corporate assets, including internal expertise, infrastructure, networks, funding and other resources.

The new ventures provide a wide range of return on investment, including:

- Access to new markets and technologies
- New revenue streams
- The opportunity to try out new business models
- Expansion beyond core business offerings
- Valuable insights into sponsor and vendor roadmaps



NFL Tech Innovation HUB - Investments

- Each entity in the NFL Tech Innovation HUB operates as an Independent Opportunity Unit (IOU) with its own dedicated resources for business and product development.
 - The incubation zone as a whole is governed by a “venture board” made up of steering committee members that determine what areas of innovation to invest in, which business plans get funded, which IOUs get follow-on funding.
 - The entire portfolio of IOUs in the incubation zone is supported by a small cross-functional team from various shared services in the productivity zone.
- 9
- **Each IOU is subject to a venture-funding discipline that requires meeting specific milestones in order to secure the next round**, typically along the following lines:
 - **Initial seed round:** Validate the technology, outline potential market opportunity
 - **Series A round:** Build a minimum viable product, confirm market opportunity
 - **Series B round:** Mature product for release at scale and production support
 - **Series C round:** Meet performance metrics set by venture board (revenue, impact,



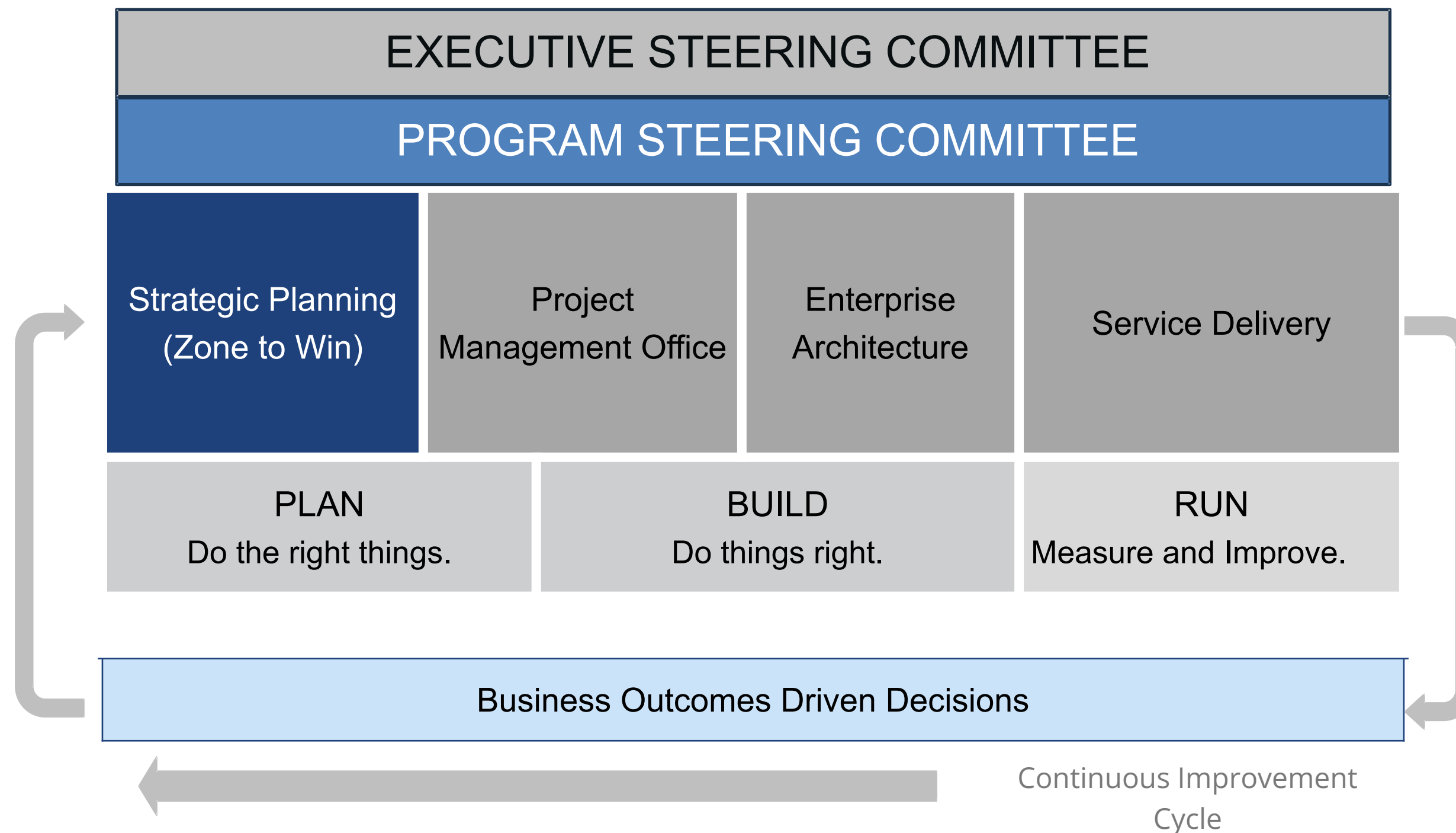
NFL Tech Innovation HUB - Growth Strategies

- **Enhanced Market Positioning:** By fostering technological innovations that resonate with market demands, the NFL can secure a leading edge in their respective sectors, ensuring increased market share and brand loyalty.
- **Revenue Growth:** The continuous incubation of novel business strategies means that the NFL always has a pipeline of new products, services, or solutions, ensuring diversified revenue streams and reduced reliance on singular income sources.
- **Operational Efficiency:** As technology is leveraged and streamlined with business goals, operational redundancies are reduced, and processes become more agile, leading to cost savings and improved profitability.
- **Partner and Stakeholder Engagement:** The collaborative nature of the hub ensures that tech innovation partners, vendors, and other stakeholders are deeply engaged, opening avenues for joint ventures, co-creation opportunities, and shared profits.
- **Long-Term Sustainability:** In an era where technological redundancy is a significant concern, the hub's proactive approach ensures businesses stay relevant, adaptable, and sustainable, offering long-term profit horizons.

9



NFL Technology Innovation Hub Governance Structure



TECH INNOVATION HUB PROGRAM STRUCTURE

EXECUTIVE STEERING COMMITTEE

STEERING COMMITTEE

**Information Technology, Player Health and Safety, Football
Operations, NFL Media, Data & Analytics, Finance, Sponsorship**

WORKING GROUP

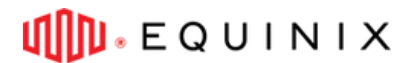
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|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| • IT | •Football Tech |
| •ISO | •NGS |
| •Broadcast | •Digital Media |
| •Player Health and Safety | •Football Business Strategy & Ops |

PHASE I PROJECTS

- OPTICAL TRACKING
- NFL VIEW
- NATURAL LANGUAGE PROCESSING, MEDIA INDEXING



Brands that have leveraged innovation framework



Next Steps

Phase 1:

- Identify cross-functional working group
- Define program goals and objectives
- Identify proof of concepts projects
- Working group workshop (training, POC project review)
- Develop communication strategy
- Establish evaluation metrics





TECHNOLOGY
INNOVATION **HUB**

THANK YOU